

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

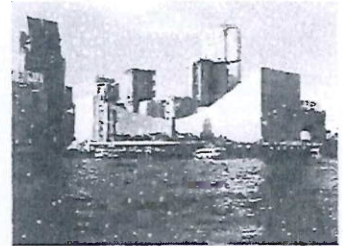
PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a local newspaper:

'Ugly' buildings

Every city has 'ugly' buildings – buildings that most citizens consider unattractive or even horrible. 'Ugly' buildings might have strange shapes, be made from unattractive materials, or simply not fit in with the other buildings around them.

In Hong Kong, the Cultural Centre in Tsim Sha Tsui was voted one of the city's ugliest buildings. Critics have said it is 'toilet-coloured', and point out that it has no windows and blocks the view of Victoria Harbour. One critic even said it should be knocked down and rebuilt.



Whether such 'ugly' buildings should be knocked down is a common subject of debate in cities. Here are two opinions on the subject in an online forum:

Yes, Ugly Buildings Should Be Knocked Down

Yes! A single ugly building can ruin a neighbourhood. We don't need to preserve everything: things change and we should move on and improve our lives, not continue the suffering of those who have to look at these architectural disasters!

No, Ugly Buildings Should Stay

Many buildings need time for people to learn to like them. People thought the Eiffel Tower was ugly when it was first built; now it's considered one of the most beautiful structures on earth. If we destroy old buildings because we think they're ugly, our city will lose its character.

Your group is working on a project about 'ugly' buildings. You are meeting to discuss the issue. You may want to talk about:

- whether it is important for buildings to look attractive
- reasons for keeping buildings that many people consider ugly
- how to decide whether a building should stay or be replaced
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like old buildings?
2. Do you have a favourite building in Hong Kong?
3. Which district in Hong Kong has the most beautiful buildings?
4. Should Hong Kong build even taller buildings?
5. Should a building be approved by the public before it is built?
6. Why do some people consider old buildings more beautiful than new buildings?
7. Do you think Hong Kong looks different to other big cities?
8. In your opinion, what makes a building beautiful?